Product Requirements Document (PRD)

University Staff Self-Service Portal

Institution: Nigeria French Language Village (NfLV), Badagry
Version: 1.0
Date: 13 October 2026
Initial scale: Approximately 500 staff users
Product type: Secure, responsive web application

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1. Executive Summary

The Nigeria French Language Village (NfLV), Badagry, requires a secure, centralised Staff Self-Service Portal that digitises staff correspondence and administrative services involving the Registry, Bursary, ICT Unit, Heads of Department and institutional management.

The portal will provide each staff member with a personal account through which they can receive official memos, manage their profile, access monthly payslips, apply for leave, track approvals, download official letters and communicate with relevant administrative units.

Authorised officers will use dedicated administrative dashboards to manage staff records, distribute correspondence, process applications, publish payslips, generate official letters and monitor outstanding requests.

The product will be developed as a responsive web application, using the institution's existing technical expertise and institutional email infrastructure wherever practical.

1.1 Product Vision

Establish one trusted digital platform through which staff can access authorised personnel information and complete routine administrative transactions without depending on paper-based correspondence or repeated physical visits to administrative offices.

1.2 Business Objectives

- Reduce paper-based memos and routine administrative correspondence.
- Improve the speed, traceability and accountability of leave approvals.
- Provide secure, timely access to payslips and personal official letters.
- Reduce manual work for Registry and Bursary officers.
- Establish a central, searchable record of staff correspondence and administrative transactions.
- Improve staff access to services from campus or off campus.

- Provide management with reliable reports on applications, correspondence and administrative workloads.

1.3 Product Scope

The initial product will include:

1. Public landing page and secure staff login.
2. Staff account and profile management.
3. Role-based access control.
4. Memo and circular distribution.
5. Payslip publication and access.
6. Leave applications and approvals.
7. Official letter generation and delivery.
8. Registry and Bursary service requests.
9. Email and in-portal notifications.
10. Administrative reports, audit trails and system configuration.

The portal is not intended to replace the institution's existing payroll calculation system, email hosting service or public website in the first release.

2. Stakeholders and User Roles

The system shall enforce role-based permissions on the server side. A user's role will determine the operations they can perform, while ownership, department, document classification and workflow status will further restrict access.

Role	Primary responsibilities
Staff	Access personal records, view memos and payslips, submit leave applications and service requests.
HR/Registry Administrator	Manage personnel records, publish authorised correspondence, verify applications and issue HR letters.
Bursary Administrator	Import approved payroll outputs, validate payslip allocations and respond to salary enquiries.
Head of Department / Supervisor	Review assigned staff requests, recommend decisions and monitor departmental cases.
Director / Authorised Approver	Make decisions on applications and correspondence within delegated authority.
Superadmin – ICT	Manage technical configuration, accounts, system availability, backups and security.

Role	Primary responsibilities
Superadmin – Institutional	Manage high-level administrative access, oversee governance and review system-wide reports within authorised scope.
Auditor / Read-only Officer	Review specifically authorised records and audit reports without changing business data.

2.1 Permission Principles

- A staff member may access only their own private records unless an additional authorised role grants access.
- Bursary personnel may access payroll data only to the extent required by their assigned duties.
- HR/Registry personnel may manage personnel records but must not automatically gain unrestricted payroll access.
- ICT administrators may manage technical operations without automatically acquiring permission to approve leave or read confidential correspondence.
- Approvers may decide only on requests routed to them under the configured workflow.
- Privileged access must be individually assigned, reviewed periodically and revoked when no longer needed.
- Emergency or exceptional access to confidential records must be restricted, justified and audited.

3. Product Architecture and Navigation

3.1 Public Landing Page

The unauthenticated landing page shall introduce the Staff Portal and provide a clear entry point for staff login.

Required components:

- NfLV logo, name and official branding.
- Welcome heading and concise portal description.
- Service highlights for correspondence, payslips, leave and profile management.
- Staff ID or institutional email login.
- Password field with optional visibility toggle.
- Forgot-password link.
- Login button with loading and error states.
- Contact information for ICT support.
- Privacy notice, terms of use and institutional footer.

- Responsive design for desktop, tablet and mobile.
- Accessible contrast, keyboard navigation and readable text.

The page must not display private staff records, internal memos, payslips or administrative reports before authentication.

3.2 Authenticated Staff Dashboard

The dashboard shall display:

- Staff name and profile summary.
- Unread memos and recent correspondence.
- Latest available payslip.
- Leave balance, subject to the institution's approved leave rules.
- Active leave applications and their statuses.
- Pending actions and requests for corrections.
- Recent letters and downloadable documents.
- Notifications and links to Registry/Bursary services.

3.3 Administrative Navigation

Administrators shall see navigation items appropriate to their permissions, such as:

- Dashboard and reports.
- Staff directory and personnel records.
- Memo and correspondence management.
- Leave applications and approval queues.
- Payslip imports and publication.
- Letter templates and document issuance.
- Service requests and enquiries.
- User roles and permissions.
- Audit records and system settings.

Hiding a navigation item is not a security control; each action and protected record must also be authorised on the server.

4. Functional Requirements

Priority definitions:

- **P0 — Must have:** Required for a secure initial production release.
- **P1 — Should have:** Important for operational completeness, potentially delivered after the first pilot.
- **P2 — Could have:** Useful enhancement for a later release.

4.1 Authentication and Account Management

ID	Requirement	Priority
AUTH-01	Authenticate users using a unique staff identifier or approved institutional email address.	P0
AUTH-02	Provide secure password reset using a verified recovery channel.	P0
AUTH-03	Enforce server-side role and resource permissions.	P0
AUTH-04	Support multi-factor authentication for privileged accounts.	P0
AUTH-05	Allow administrators to activate, suspend and deactivate accounts.	P0
AUTH-06	Apply rate limits and protections against repeated login attempts.	P0
AUTH-07	Support logout and session expiry according to security policy.	P0
AUTH-08	Record relevant authentication and account-management events.	P0
AUTH-09	Provision staff accounts through an authorised bulk-import process.	P0
AUTH-10	Support institutional single sign-on if a compatible identity provider is available.	P1

Account provisioning must prevent duplicate staff accounts and provide a safe procedure for resolving mismatched staff identifiers.

4.2 Staff Profile Management

ID	Requirement	Priority
PROF-01	Allow staff to view their own authorised personnel profile.	P0
PROF-02	Include approved fields such as staff number, name, department, designation and employment status.	P0
PROF-03	Allow staff to request changes to permitted personal information.	P0
PROF-04	Require approval for changes to sensitive or official employment fields.	P0
PROF-05	Retain a history of material profile changes.	P0
PROF-06	Allow authorised Registry staff to create, correct and deactivate personnel records.	P0
PROF-07	Allow staff to view profile-update request status.	P1
PROF-08	Support controlled imports of existing personnel records.	P0

The system must distinguish editable contact information from official employment information. A staff member must not directly change their grade level, salary, employment status or bank details without the relevant verification process.

4.3 Memo and Correspondence Management

ID	Requirement	Priority
MEM-01	Allow authorised officers to create, edit, preview and publish memos.	P0

ID	Requirement	Priority
MEM-02	Support recipients by individual, department, staff group or institution-wide distribution.	P0
MEM-03	Restrict confidential memos to authorised recipients.	P0
MEM-04	Support draft, pending approval, published, withdrawn and archived states.	P0
MEM-05	Support approved document attachments.	P0
MEM-06	Allow staff to view and download correspondence addressed to them.	P0
MEM-07	Send in-portal and email notifications for published correspondence.	P0
MEM-08	Record intended recipients and delivery, viewing or acknowledgement events as applicable.	P0
MEM-09	Support search and filtering by date, subject, category and status.	P1
MEM-10	Support scheduled publication and expiry dates.	P1
MEM-11	Provide version history and an auditable withdrawal process.	P1

A published memo must not silently change after recipients have accessed it. Material corrections should produce a new version or replacement record, with appropriate notification and an audit trail.

4.4 Payslip Management

ID	Requirement	Priority
PAY-01	Allow authorised Bursary users to upload approved payslips individually or in batches.	P0
PAY-02	Associate each payslip with the correct staff identifier and payroll period.	P0
PAY-03	Validate file format, staff matching, duplicates and missing records before publication.	P0
PAY-04	Require designated approval of a batch before publication.	P0
PAY-05	Allow staff to view and download only their own authorised payslips.	P0
PAY-06	Notify staff when a payslip is published.	P0
PAY-07	Maintain historical payslips according to the approved retention policy.	P0
PAY-08	Record who imported, validated, approved and published a batch.	P0
PAY-09	Support controlled replacement of incorrectly allocated payslips.	P0
PAY-10	Provide reconciliation reports for successful, failed, missing and duplicate records.	P1
PAY-11	Support integration with existing payroll software when interfaces and security requirements are confirmed.	P1

Initial implementation: the portal distributes approved payroll outputs; it does not calculate salaries or alter payroll results.

A batch must not become visible to staff until validation and approval are complete. The system must prevent one staff member from retrieving another person's payslip by modifying a URL, identifier or request parameter.

4.5 Leave Application and Approval

ID	Requirement	Priority
LEAVE-01	Allow staff to view applicable leave categories and available entitlement where maintained.	P0
LEAVE-02	Accept leave type, start date, end date, reason and required attachments.	P0
LEAVE-03	Validate required fields and flag overlapping or invalid date ranges.	P0
LEAVE-04	Route applications according to configurable approval rules.	P0
LEAVE-05	Allow approvers to approve, reject or return applications for correction.	P0
LEAVE-06	Allow staff to track application status and history.	P0
LEAVE-07	Generate an official approval or rejection letter from an approved template.	P0
LEAVE-08	Notify staff and relevant officers when an application changes status.	P0
LEAVE-09	Maintain an audit trail of every decision and reassignment.	P0

ID	Requirement	Priority
LEAVE-10	Calculate leave duration using approved rules for weekends, public holidays and applicable exclusions.	P0
LEAVE-11	Update leave balances according to approved entitlement rules.	P0
LEAVE-12	Support delegated approval and escalation of overdue requests.	P1
LEAVE-13	Provide reports on pending applications, leave usage and upcoming approved absences.	P1

The approval route must be configurable by leave type and staff category. The software shall not presume that every leave application follows the same sequence or that all staff have identical entitlement rules.

4.6 Official Letter Generation

ID	Requirement	Priority
DOC-01	Allow authorised users to create and manage approved document templates.	P0
DOC-02	Support authorised staff details, dates, reference numbers and approved fields in templates.	P0
DOC-03	Generate PDF letters for approved transactions.	P0
DOC-04	Assign unique reference numbers according to an approved institutional convention.	P0

ID	Requirement	Priority
DOC-05	Restrict approval and issuance to appropriately authorised officers.	P0
DOC-06	Store the issued version and issuance metadata.	P0
DOC-07	Allow staff to retrieve issued letters from their private document area.	P0
DOC-08	Support electronic signatures or verified approval marks where institutionally authorised.	P1
DOC-09	Support annual increment and promotion letters through configurable templates.	P1

A generated document must not be represented as formally signed or approved unless the required approval has actually occurred. Template updates must not silently alter letters already issued.

4.7 Registry and Bursary Service Requests

ID	Requirement	Priority
SRV-01	Allow staff to submit requests to the appropriate administrative unit.	P0
SRV-02	Assign a unique tracking reference to each request.	P0
SRV-03	Support categories, descriptions and authorised attachments.	P0
SRV-04	Allow authorised officers to assign, respond to, escalate and close requests.	P0

ID	Requirement	Priority
SRV-05	Allow staff to view the status and response history of their own requests.	P0
SRV-06	Notify relevant users of assignments, responses and closure.	P0
SRV-07	Support service-level targets, overdue queues and performance reports.	P1

Requests concerning salary, bank details or other confidential matters must inherit appropriate access restrictions.

4.8 Notifications

The system shall provide:

- In-portal notifications for new memos, payslips, approvals, rejections and service-request responses.
- Email notifications through the institution's existing email infrastructure.
- Notification preferences where permitted by institutional policy.
- Retry and failure logging for unsuccessful email deliveries.
- Queue processing for bulk notifications, avoiding long delays during normal user requests.
- Generic notification content for sensitive matters, directing users to sign in rather than including confidential details in email.

An email delivery failure must not erase the underlying portal record or falsely indicate that the email was delivered.

4.9 Administration and Reporting

Authorised administrators shall be able to:

- View dashboard summaries appropriate to their role.
- Search staff records within their authorised scope.
- Monitor pending leave applications and unresolved service requests.
- Review memo publication and acknowledgement statistics.
- View payslip batch reconciliation results.
- Generate approved operational reports.
- Export permitted reports using controlled access and audit logging.
- Configure approval rules, document templates and notification settings within their authority.

- Review audit records according to their assigned permissions.

Reports must not expose personal salary details to managers who are not authorised to view them.

5. Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Category	Requirement / acceptance target
NFR-01	Capacity	Support 500 registered staff and authorised administrative users, with capacity for future growth.
NFR-02	Performance	Target a 95th-percentile response time of 2 seconds or less for routine authenticated pages under the agreed test load, excluding large downloads and external email delays.
NFR-03	Availability	Target at least 99.5% monthly availability, excluding agreed maintenance windows.
NFR-04	Security	Use HTTPS, secure session handling, validated input, server-side authorisation and protected secrets.
NFR-05	Privacy	Prevent unauthorised access to staff profiles, payslips, leave records and confidential correspondence.
NFR-06	Accessibility	Target WCAG 2.2 Level AA for key user journeys.
NFR-07	Compatibility	Support current versions of major desktop and mobile browsers.

ID	Category	Requirement / acceptance target
NFR-08	Responsiveness	Support common desktop, tablet and smartphone screen sizes without a separate mobile application.
NFR-09	Recoverability	Establish approved recovery-point and recovery-time objectives, with tested restoration procedures.
NFR-10	Auditability	Record sensitive changes and administrative decisions with actor, timestamp, action and affected record.
NFR-11	Maintainability	Use modular code, automated tests, documented configuration and controlled database migrations.
NFR-12	Data integrity	Use transactions and validation to prevent inconsistent approval, publication and balance updates.
NFR-13	Scalability	Permit additional modules and users without requiring an architectural rewrite.
NFR-14	Data retention	Apply approved retention and disposal schedules to personnel documents, payslips and audit records.

Performance and availability figures are proposed service targets. They must be validated against hosting capacity, connectivity, actual usage patterns and the institution's support budget before becoming operational commitments.

5.1 Security Standards and Controls

The implementation shall incorporate:

- Protection against common web application risks, informed by the OWASP Top 10.
- Secure password hashing using framework-supported algorithms.
- Multi-factor authentication for privileged users.
- Least-privilege role assignments and resource-level authorisation.
- CSRF protection, output escaping, input validation and safe database queries.
- File upload restrictions, including allowed file types, size limits and malware scanning where available.
- Private storage for payslips and confidential attachments.
- Rate limiting and monitoring of suspicious authentication activity.
- Encrypted backups and appropriate protection of data in transit and at rest.
- Controlled production access, secret management and timely security updates.
- A documented security incident response process.

The institution should assess its obligations under the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023 and applicable Nigeria Data Protection Commission requirements, including appropriate notices, access controls, retention, incident handling and any required data-protection impact assessment.

6. Proposed Database Entities

Entity	Key information
`users`	Account identity, password hash, status and authentication metadata
`staff_profiles`	Staff number, name, department, designation and employment data
`departments`	Department code, name and active status
`roles`	Defined user roles
`permissions`	Permitted actions
`role_assignments`	User roles and optional scope
`memos`	Subject, content, classification, author and publication state
`memo_recipients`	Intended recipient, delivery and acknowledgement metadata
`documents`	File reference, document category, version and ownership
`payslip_batches`	Payroll period, uploader, validation results and release status

Entity	Key information
payslips	Staff association, period, private document reference and publication status
leave_types	Approved leave categories and applicable rules
leave_entitlements	Staff entitlement records for a defined period
leave_applications	Dates, reason, duration, applicant and current status
approval_steps	Assigned approver, decision, comments and timestamps
letter_templates	Approved templates, version and permitted fields
issued_letters	Reference number, recipient, issuing officer and final document
service_requests	Request category, owner, assigned unit, status and response history
notifications	Recipient, channel, delivery status and retry information
audit_logs	Actor, action, affected record, timestamp and relevant context
system_settings	Approved workflow, retention and configuration settings

6.1 Data Design Rules

1. Every staff member shall have a unique institutional staff number.
2. Staff accounts shall reference personnel records through stable identifiers rather than names.
3. Every private document shall have an explicit owner or authorised recipient set.
4. Approval decisions shall be preserved as historical records rather than overwritten without trace.
5. Payslip publication and leave approval shall use database transactions where multiple related records must change together.
6. File contents shall be stored in private storage, not directly in publicly accessible web directories.
7. The system shall distinguish between soft deletion, account deactivation and formal records disposal.
8. Access to audit logs shall be restricted and protected against unauthorised alteration.
9. Retention and disposal rules shall be configurable according to approved institutional policy and legal requirements.

7. Core Business Workflows

7.1 Leave Application State Machine

```
flowchart TD
    A[Staff drafts application] --> B[Submit application]
    B --> C[Validate dates and required fields]
    C -->|Invalid| D[Return validation errors]
    D --> A
    C -->|Valid| E[Pending review]
    E --> F[Supervisor review if required]
    F -->|Return| G[Returned for correction]
    G --> A
    F -->|Reject| H[Rejected]
    F -->|Recommend| I[HR verification]
    E --> I
    I -->|Needs correction| G
    I -->|Verified| J[Authorised approver]
    J -->|Reject| H
    J -->|Approve| K[Record approval]
    K --> L[Generate official letter]
    L --> M[Notify staff and update balance]
```

The precise path must be configurable. A leave category that does not require supervisor review shall not be forced through that stage. The system must also handle withdrawal, cancellation and correction of previously approved leave under controlled rules.

7.2 Payslip Publication Workflow

```
flowchart TD
    A[Bursary uploads batch] --> B[Validate file and staff matching]
    B --> C{Validation results}
    C -->|Errors| D[Quarantine errors and prepare report]
    D --> E[Bursary corrects and resubmits]
    E --> B
    C -->|Valid| F[Authorised release review]
    F -->|Rejected| E
    F -->|Approved| G[Publish to individual accounts]
    G --> H[Record publication audit]
    H --> I[Send generic email notifications]
    I --> J[Staff securely views own payslip]
```

A batch with unresolved material errors shall not be released. Publication shall be idempotent so retrying a failed operation does not accidentally duplicate payslips or notifications.

7.3 Memo Publication Workflow

```
flowchart TD
    A[Author drafts memo] --> B[Select recipients and classification]
    B --> C[Submit for approval if required]
    C --> D{Decision}
    D -->|Return| A
    D -->|Reject| E[Retain rejected draft]
    D -->|Approve or no approval required| F[Publish memo]
    F --> G[Create recipient records]
    G --> H[Notify intended recipients]
    H --> I[Record views and acknowledgements]
```

8. Document Generation Requirements

Official letters must use institution-approved templates and a consistent document identity.

Each issued letter should contain, where applicable:

- Institution name, logo and official heading.
- Unique reference number.
- Issue date and recipient details.
- Subject and approved letter content.
- Authorised signatory's name and designation.
- Approval or signature information supported by the system.
- Appropriate classification or confidentiality marking.
- A document version or verification reference, where required.

The institution shall determine whether electronic signatures, scanned signatures or a digitally verifiable approval mechanism are acceptable for each document type. A scanned signature image alone must not be treated as proof of document integrity or authenticity.

9. User Experience and Accessibility

The portal shall provide a consistent interface across public, staff and administrative areas.

9.1 Design Requirements

- Use official NfLV branding and an institution-approved colour palette.
- Display a clear primary action on each page.
- Use plain language for application statuses and validation errors.
- Provide confirmation screens for important actions.
- Distinguish clearly between drafts, submitted requests, approvals and rejected requests.
- Show loading, empty, success and error states.

- Support keyboard navigation, visible focus indicators and accessible form labels.
- Avoid relying on colour alone to communicate status.
- Confirm before destructive or irreversible actions.

9.2 Required Status Labels

The system should use a consistent set of statuses, including:

- Draft
- Submitted
- Pending review
- Pending approval
- Returned for correction
- Approved
- Rejected
- Published
- Withdrawn
- Cancelled
- Closed

Only statuses relevant to a particular module should be shown to users.

10. Technical Implementation Requirements

10.1 Recommended Stack

Component	Technology
Backend framework	Laravel
Frontend	Blade + Livewire
Styling	Tailwind CSS
Database	PostgreSQL
Authentication	Laravel authentication with MFA for privileged users
Permissions	Laravel policies and gates; optionally Spatie Laravel Permission
Queue processing	Laravel queues, with Redis introduced when needed
PDF generation	Dompdf or an appropriate server-side PDF library
Email delivery	Institutional SMTP
Private document storage	Private filesystem or private object storage
Web server	Nginx + PHP-FPM on a supported Linux distribution
Version control	Git with protected branches and reviewed changes

Component	Technology
Automated testing	Pest or PHPUnit
Deployment	Separate development, staging and production environments
Monitoring	Application logs, availability checks and backup alerts

10.2 Application Modules

The codebase should be organised into distinct modules or clearly separated application domains:

1. Identity and access management.
2. Staff directory and profile management.
3. Correspondence and memo management.
4. Payroll document distribution.
5. Leave management.
6. Workflow and approval engine.
7. Document templates and issuance.
8. Service requests.
9. Notifications.
10. Reporting and audit.
11. System configuration.

A modular monolith is recommended for the first release. It avoids the operational complexity of microservices while preserving clear boundaries between business functions.

10.3 Integration Requirements

The initial release shall integrate with:

- The institutional email system for notifications and recovery messages.
- Existing personnel records through controlled import.
- Existing payroll outputs through approved file imports.

Potential later integrations include institutional single sign-on, payroll APIs, digital signature services and existing HR information systems.

Every integration shall have defined permissions, error handling, data validation and operational ownership. No integration should require sharing an administrator's personal credentials.

11. Acceptance Criteria

ID	Test scenario	Expected result
AC-01	A valid staff member logs in.	The correct personal dashboard is displayed.
AC-02	An unauthorised user attempts to open a private staff URL.	Access is denied without revealing protected content.
AC-03	Staff member A attempts to view staff member B's payslip.	The request is denied and the event is logged appropriately.
AC-04	Registry publishes a memo to a selected department.	Only intended, authorised recipients can access it.
AC-05	Bursary uploads a batch containing a mismatched staff number.	The error is identified and the affected payslip is not incorrectly published.
AC-06	Staff submits a valid leave application.	The application is saved and routed to the correct configured approver.
AC-07	An approver rejects an application.	The decision, timestamp and required comments are retained; the staff member is notified.
AC-08	An authorised approver approves leave.	The approved transaction produces the correct official letter and updates leave records according to policy.
AC-09	Staff submits a profile correction.	The request follows the required verification process before the official record changes.
AC-10	A privileged administrator changes a role assignment.	The change is authorised, recorded and reflected in subsequent permission checks.
AC-11	Email delivery fails.	The underlying record remains available and the notification failure can be retried or investigated.

ID	Test scenario	Expected result
AC-12	A backup restoration test is performed.	The database and required documents are restored within approved recovery objectives.
AC-13	Two authorised officers act on the same pending application.	Conflicting decisions are prevented or handled safely with an auditable outcome.
AC-14	The application is tested with the agreed concurrent user load.	Performance and stability targets are met without unauthorised access or data loss.
AC-15	A staff account is deactivated.	The user can no longer sign in, while historical records are retained according to policy.

Production acceptance shall require documented functional testing, permission testing, security testing, backup restoration, user acceptance and sign-off by designated institutional representatives.

12. Rollout and Implementation Plan

The proposed implementation schedule is approximately 14 weeks for a focused initial release, assuming an available development team, timely policy decisions and suitable hosting. This is a planning estimate rather than a guaranteed delivery date.

Phase	Indicative timing	Deliverables
1. Discovery	Weeks 1–2	Approved requirements, process maps, roles and policy decisions
2. Foundation	Weeks 3–5	Authentication, permissions, staff records, audit logging and core interface
3. Correspondence	Weeks 6–7	Memo distribution, document storage and notifications
4. Payslips	Week 8	Validated batch import and private payslip access

Phase	Indicative timing	Deliverables
5. Leave	Weeks 9–10	Applications, approvals, balances and approval letters
6. Service requests	Week 11	Registry/Bursary enquiries and tracking
7. Testing and hardening	Weeks 12–13	Security, performance, integration and recovery testing
8. Pilot and release	Week 14	Pilot sign-off, training and staged staff onboarding

Some activities can run in parallel, while security testing and production readiness must remain release gates.

12.1 Pilot Group

Start with approximately 20–30 users from ICT, Registry, Bursary and selected departments. Include ordinary staff, supervisors, approvers and administrative users.

The pilot shall test:

- Staff onboarding and account recovery.
- Memo publication and access restrictions.
- Payslip upload, reconciliation and private access.
- Leave submission, review and approval letters.
- Profile update requests.
- Email failures and notification retries.
- Audit logs and backup restoration.

Use synthetic payroll and personnel data during development and demonstrations. Production data may be introduced only after authorisation and the required security checks.

12.2 Staff Onboarding

After successful pilot sign-off:

1. Import and reconcile the authorised staff register.
2. Verify staff numbers, departments and institutional email addresses.
3. Issue account activation instructions securely.
4. Train administrative officers and approvers.
5. Publish user guidance and ICT support contact details.
6. Onboard staff in controlled batches.

7. Monitor login failures, unresolved requests and support tickets during the initial operating period.

13. Project Team and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Executive sponsor	Provides institutional sponsorship and resolves cross-departmental issues.
Product owner	Prioritises requirements and accepts delivered functionality.
Registry/HR subject-matter expert	Defines personnel rules, correspondence and leave processes.
Bursary subject-matter expert	Defines payslip formats, reconciliation and release approval.
ICT lead / technical architect	Owns architecture, deployment, security and technical decisions.
Backend developer	Implements business rules, database operations and integrations.
Frontend developer	Implements responsive interfaces and accessible user flows.
QA/test engineer	Maintains test cases, validates workflows and records defects.
Data protection / legal representative	Reviews applicable privacy obligations, retention and notices.
Departmental pilot representatives	Test real workflows and provide operational feedback.

One person may fulfil multiple roles in a small team, but product approval, sensitive business decisions and technical access should still have clear accountability.

14. Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Potential impact	Mitigation
Incorrect staff data	Payslips or letters assigned to the wrong person	Reconcile staff identifiers and validate imports before release.
Unauthorised document access	Exposure of confidential information	Enforce server-side permissions, private storage and security testing.

Risk	Potential impact	Mitigation
Unclear approval authority	Delays or invalid decisions	Obtain approved workflow definitions before configuration.
Email delivery failure	Staff miss important notifications	Retain portal notifications, log failures and provide retries.
Payroll import errors	Incorrect or incomplete payslip publication	Validate batches, quarantine exceptions and require release approval.
Staff resistance or limited adoption	Continued reliance on paper processes	Provide training, support and a clear transition plan.
Loss of data or system outage	Interrupted administrative services	Maintain separate backups, monitor availability and test restoration.
Scope expansion	Budget overruns and delayed delivery	Use phased releases and formal change control.
Developer dependency	Difficulty maintaining the portal	Document the codebase, use version control and maintain institutional ownership.
Regulatory non-compliance	Legal and reputational consequences	Review applicable data protection and records-management obligations before launch.

15. Out of Scope for the Initial Release

The following capabilities are excluded unless separately approved:

- Payroll calculations and salary disbursement.
- Full accounting or financial management.
- Recruitment and applicant tracking.
- Student information management.
- Library, hostel and student payment systems.
- A native Android or iOS application.
- Automatic electronic signatures without an approved signature process.
- Replacing the institution's existing email hosting service.
- Unrestricted editing of official personnel or salary records by staff.

The architecture should allow future integrations without requiring these systems to be built into the first release.

16. Success Metrics

The institution should establish baseline measurements before deployment and evaluate performance after launch.

Metric	Proposed initial target
Staff onboarding	At least 95% of the 500 staff accounts provisioned and reconciled by the agreed rollout deadline.
Payslip availability	At least 98% of valid payslips in an approved batch successfully published to the correct staff accounts within the agreed service window.
Leave tracking	100% of submitted applications have a traceable status and history.
Correspondence	100% of published memos have recorded intended recipients.
Security	Zero unresolved critical or high-severity security findings at production release.
Auditability	100% of designated sensitive actions generate the required audit records.
Staff adoption	At least 80% of staff have activated their accounts within the agreed adoption period.
Reliability	Meet the approved availability and recovery objectives.
Support	Track request resolution time, overdue cases and recurring problems.

These are proposed targets, not existing performance figures. The institution should confirm the measurement period, service windows and baseline before adopting them formally.

17. Governance and Decisions Required

Before development begins, the project steering group should approve the following:

- ☐ Product owner and executive sponsor.
- ☐ Official staff register and unique staff-number format.
- ☐ Role-permission matrix and departmental responsibilities.
- ☐ Leave categories, entitlement rules and approval chains.
- ☐ Memo classifications and distribution rules.
- ☐ Payslip file format, payroll reconciliation and release procedure.

- ☐ Official letter templates, reference numbering and signature rules.
- ☐ Hosting arrangements, backup policy and recovery objectives.
- ☐ Data retention policy, privacy notices and security responsibilities.
- ☐ Email delivery configuration and support arrangements.
- ☐ Pilot acceptance criteria, release approval and ongoing maintenance ownership.

18. Definition of Done

The initial portal shall be considered ready for production when:

1. All P0 requirements are implemented and tested.
2. All critical staff journeys work from login through completion.
3. Role and document-access restrictions pass negative testing.
4. Payslip imports and leave approvals pass end-to-end testing.
5. Required email notifications, retries and failure logs are operational.
6. Official document templates have been approved.
7. Backup restoration and incident response procedures have been tested.
8. No unresolved critical or high-severity security findings remain.
9. User documentation and administrator training are complete.
10. The pilot has passed its acceptance criteria and authorised institutional representatives have signed off.

Recommended Next Step

This PRD provides the product requirements and proposed delivery boundaries. The next deliverable should be a **Software Requirements Specification (SRS) and technical design package** containing:

- Detailed database schema and entity relationships.
- Complete role-permission matrix.
- Laravel project folder and module structure.
- API and integration specifications where required.
- Screen-by-screen wireframes for the landing page, staff dashboard and admin dashboards.
- Detailed approval and document-generation rules.
- Test cases mapped to each requirement.
- Deployment, backup and security configuration.

That package will give the IT team a practical implementation guide and reduce the risk of building features that do not match the institution's actual Registry, Bursary and management processes.